

Codex Slack Alerts Setup

Phone notifications using a Slack Incoming Webhook

Prepared for Joe

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Bottom line: With the Slack app/webhook you just created, Slack can **notify** you when Codex finishes or needs attention. You generally **cannot reply in Slack and have Codex continue** using an Incoming Webhook alone. For now: Slack pings your phone, then you SSH back into the machine and reattach to the Codex session in `tmux`.

1. Can I respond in Slack?

Not with only an Incoming Webhook.

Goal	Incoming Webhook?	Notes
Post Codex alerts into Slack	Yes	Codex runs a notify script that sends JSON to the Slack webhook URL.
See alerts on your phone	Yes	Set the Slack alert channel to notify on all new messages.
Reply in Slack and have Codex continue	No, not with webhook alone	Incoming webhooks post messages into Slack; they do not receive replies from Slack.
Build true Slack interaction	Yes, but more work	Requires a real Slack bot/interactivity endpoint or slash command plus a safe bridge to the Codex session.

Recommended setup: Use Slack only as the alert channel. Keep the real Codex interaction in the terminal, preserved by `tmux`.

2. Target workflow

```
Codex running in tmux
->
Codex notify hook
->
~/local/bin/codex-slack-notify.sh
->
Slack Incoming Webhook
->
#codex-alerts on your phone
->
SSH from phone, then: tmux attach -t codex
```

3. Store the Slack webhook secret

Create a private secrets file and keep the webhook URL out of your repo.

```
mkdir -p ~/.config/secrets
chmod 700 ~/.config/secrets

vi ~/.config/secrets/env
```

Put this in the file:

```
export SLACK_CODEX_WEBHOOK_URL='https://hooks.slack.com/services/XXX/YYY/ZZZ'
```

Lock it down:

```
chmod 600 ~/.config/secrets/env
```

Security note: Do not paste the webhook URL into GitHub, screenshots, tickets, prompts, Slack messages, or code files. Treat it like a password.

4. Load the secret in your shell

Edit ~/.profile:

```
vi ~/.profile
```

Add this near the bottom:

```
# Load private environment secrets
if [ -f "$HOME/.config/secrets/env" ]; then
  . "$HOME/.config/secrets/env"
fi
```

Reload it:

```
source ~/.profile
```

Quick check:

```
echo "$SLACK_CODEX_WEBHOOK_URL"
```

5. Create the Slack notifier script

```
mkdir -p ~/.local/bin
vi ~/.local/bin/codex-slack-notify.sh
```

Paste this script:

```
#!/usr/bin/env bash
set -euo pipefail

# Codex passes a JSON payload as the first arg.
PAYLOAD="${1:-{}}"

# Load secrets when Codex starts from a shell that has not sourced ~/.profile.
if [ -f "$HOME/.config/secrets/env" ]; then
    . "$HOME/.config/secrets/env"
fi

if [ -z "${SLACK_CODEX_WEBHOOK_URL:-}" ]; then
    exit 0
fi

MESSAGE="$(python3 - "$PAYLOAD" <<'PY'
import json
import sys

try:
    j = json.loads(sys.argv[1])
    event_type = j.get("type", "codex")
    cwd = j.get("cwd", "")
    last = j.get("last-assistant-message") or "Codex turn complete / needs attention."

    if len(last) > 900:
        last = last[:900] + "..."

    text = f"*Codex:* '{event_type}'\n{last}"
    if cwd:
        text += f"\n\n*Dir:* '{cwd}'"

    print(json.dumps({"text": text}))
except Exception:
    print(json.dumps({"text": "Codex needs attention."}))
PY
)"

curl -fsS \
  -X POST \
  -H 'Content-type: application/json' \
  --data "$MESSAGE" \
  "$SLACK_CODEX_WEBHOOK_URL" >/dev/null
```

Make it executable:

```
chmod +x ~/.local/bin/codex-slack-notify.sh
```

6. Test the Slack webhook script

Run this shorter test command:

```
~/.local/bin/codex-slack-notify.sh '{"type":"test","last-assistant-message":"Slack test from Codex notifier","cwd":"/tmp"}'
```

You should see a message in your Slack channel. On your phone, set that channel to notify you for **all new messages**.

7. Configure Codex

Edit your Codex config:

```
mkdir -p ~/.codex
vi ~/.codex/config.toml
```

Add or adjust:

```
notify = ["bash", "/home/joe/.local/bin/codex-slack-notify.sh"]

[tui]
notifications = ["agent-turn-complete", "approval-requested"]
notification_method = "auto"
```

If your Linux username is not `joe`, change the script path accordingly.

Important limitation: The external Codex notify hook is useful for completion/attention pings. Depending on the Codex version, approval-request events may be better supported in local TUI notifications than in external phone pings. The Slack notification is still very useful for “come back and check Codex.”

8. Run Codex inside tmux

This keeps the session alive while you are away.

```
sudo apt install tmux

tmux new -s codex
codex
```

Detach before walking away:

```
Ctrl+b, then d
```

When Slack pings your phone, SSH into the machine and reattach:

```
tmux attach -t codex
```

9. If you really want to reply inside Slack later

That is possible, but it is a different project. You would need:

- a Slack bot user
- Slack interactivity or slash commands
- a public or tunneled request URL
- Slack request signature verification
- a small local or server-side service
- a safe bridge from Slack to the machine running Codex
- strict permissions so Slack messages cannot blindly execute shell commands

I would not start there. First get simple alerts working. Then use phone SSH/tmux to answer Codex. That is much easier, safer, and less brittle.

10. Quick checklist

- ☐ Slack app created and Incoming Webhook installed into a private channel.
- ☐ Webhook URL saved in `~/.config/secrets/env`, not in the repo.
- ☐ `~/.profile` sources `~/.config/secrets/env`.
- ☐ `codex-slack-notify.sh` exists and is executable.
- ☐ Manual test posts to Slack successfully.
- ☐ `~/.codex/config.toml` points `notify` at the script.
- ☐ Codex runs inside `tmux`.
- ☐ Phone has Slack notifications enabled for the alert channel.

References

Slack Developer Docs: Incoming Webhooks. Slack Developer Docs: Interactivity. OpenAI Codex Docs: Advanced Configuration / notify hook.